

Figure 1: To search for an application or file in Quicksilver, just type in the Subject box



Figure 2: Quicksilver starts throwing up options that tally with your search even before you finish typing

A commanding performance

A simple example will suffice. Suppose I were searching my Mac for my photographs. I would then open Quicksilver, search for Nimish and then, from the options displayed, would pick the photograph (yes, you can tweak the settings to show you a preview) and click on it to open it. But that's only part of Quicksilver's magic. What if I had actually wanted to copy or delete a particular photograph or to just rename it or move it to another folder? Well, using Quicksilver I can do exactly that and much more, without having to open the photograph. All I need to do is select it from the options shown and then choose from one of the many actions that Quicksilver offers. I can even choose to open a file with a particular program, if need be. Another advantage that Quicksilver has is that it keeps track of the applications and folders you use and when you are doing a search, shows the most used options right up front—very handy indeed.

What's also staggering is the speed at which Quicksilver performs. Although it does not do a system wide launch like Spotlight does, it more often than not delivers the result you want literally in the blink of an eye. Spotlight supporters will point out that their tool is much better for looking for an item whose name you might have forgotten, but if you know what you are looking for, Quicksilver seems a much better option, especially because it is likely to show you what you are looking for the time you have finished typing the first letter! What's more, you can even add functionalities to it, such as the option to send instant messages, dial phone numbers, search for terms in a dictionary and so on—all without compromising on speed.

And as if that were not enough, you can add a number of functionalities to Quicksilver by downloading a number of plug-ins. These enable you to accomplish a number of



Figure 3: You can not only access a file, but can even carry out a number of actions such as renaming, deleting or copying it

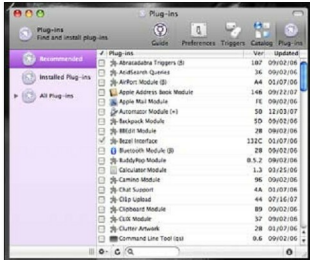


Figure 4: A number of functions can be added to Quicksilver using its extensive library of plug-ins, accessible from within the application itself

tasks without opening specific applications—for instance, you can use the Apple Mail module or the Gmail module to send mails and even play around with folders without having to open Apple Mail or go to the Gmail website. You can also resize and tweak images, and assign ratings to your iTunes library by using the requisite plug-ins. And you do not have to go about searching for plug-ins for Quicksilver—you can access them from within the application itself by choosing the 'Plug-ins' option.

Yes, it does have its shortcomings. Its searches are not as comprehensive as Spotlight and you have to type what you are looking for really fast—a single pause is considered as the end of the search and the application starts treating every letter you type after that pause as part of a new search. But its phenomenal turn of speed and the fact that it allows you to execute commands with minimum fuss makes Quicksilver a big hit among Mac fans, even after Apple boosted Spotlight considerably. Definitely worth a download if you happen to be using a Mac. **END**

By: Nimish Dubey

The author is a freelance writer with a passion for IT. He can be reached at nimishdubey@gmail.com